

The Coca-Cola Company

True to Form

KO's updated 2025 EPS outlook is now at the high end of the prior range (+3%), which is in-line with where we and Consensus were already anchored.

Visibility into +3% all-in EPS growth for the year is driven by 2Q outperformance, with this quarter's margin beat effectively a pull-forward of what was previously expected to be a 2H-weighted story. Yesterday's discussion felt characteristically strong, with the company conveying its usual sense of having things generally under control and the flexibility to navigate as needed when an unforeseen challenge arises in a given market. We once again reiterate our Overweight rating given we think KO's OSG profile, consistent long-term strategy and tactical agility screen highly attractive.

KO: Quarterly and Annual EPS (USD)

FY Dec	2024	2025			2026			Change y/y	
	Actual	Old	New	Cons	Old	New	Cons	2025	2026
Q1	0.72A	0.73A	0.73A	0.73A	0.79E	0.80E	0.79E	1%	10%
Q2	0.84A	0.83E	0.87A	0.83E	0.91E	0.94E	0.91E	4%	8%
Q3	0.77A	0.81E	0.79E	0.81E	0.89E	0.86E	0.87E	3%	9%
Q4	0.55A	0.60E	0.58E	0.61E	0.64E	0.63E	0.66E	5%	9%
Year	2.88A	2.97E	2.97E	2.97E	3.23E	3.23E	3.21E	3%	9%
P/E	24.1		23.5			21.6			

Consensus numbers are from Bloomberg received on 22-Jul-2025; 12:50 GMT
Source: Barclays Research

KO	OVERWEIGHT Unchanged
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL Unchanged
Price Target	USD 78.00 Unchanged
Price (22-Jul-25)	USD 69.66
Potential Upside/Downside	+12.0%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

Market Cap (USD mn)	299835
Shares Outstanding (mn)	4304.27
Free Float (%)	81.68
52 Wk Avg Daily Volume (mn)	16.4
Dividend Yield (%)	2.93
Return on Equity TTM (%)	44.76
Current BVPS (USD)	6.64
Source: Bloomberg	

Price Performance	Exchange-NYSE
52 Week range	USD 74.38-60.62



Source: IDC
[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

NEUTRAL

The Coca-Cola Company (KO)

OVERWEIGHT

Income statement (US\$m)	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	CAGR
Revenue	46,897	48,531	51,401	54,346	5.0%
EBITDA (adj)	15,160	16,258	17,519	18,791	7.4%
EBIT (adj)	14,085	15,094	16,285	17,487	7.5%
Pre-tax income (adj)	15,333	16,194	17,448	18,770	7.0%
Net income (adj)	12,463	12,808	13,941	14,998	6.4%
EPS (adj) (US\$)	2.88	2.97	3.23	3.48	6.4%
Diluted shares (mn)	4,320.3	4,314.5	4,315.0	4,315.0	0.0%
DPS (US\$)	1.94	2.04	2.12	2.21	4.4%
Margin and return data	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	Average
Gross margin (%)	61.1	61.5	61.9	62.2	61.7
EBITDA (adj) margin (%)	32.3	33.5	34.1	34.6	33.6
EBIT (adj) margin (%)	30.0	31.1	31.7	32.2	31.2
Pre-tax (adj) margin (%)	32.7	33.4	33.9	34.5	33.6
Net (adj) margin (%)	26.6	26.4	27.1	27.6	26.9
ROIC (%)	25.6	24.9	25.6	26.3	25.6
ROA (%)	11.4	11.7	12.0	12.2	11.8
ROE (%)	47.3	52.0	46.6	42.2	47.0
Balance sheet and cash flow (US\$m)	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	CAGR
Cash and equivalents	10,828	8,463	10,743	13,914	8.7%
Total assets	100,549	102,579	108,646	114,870	4.5%
Short and long-term debt	44,522	47,212	47,212	47,212	2.0%
Total liabilities	74,177	77,934	78,760	79,323	2.3%
Net debt/(funds)	29,951	35,006	32,726	29,555	-0.4%
Shareholders' equity	26,372	24,645	29,886	35,547	10.5%
Change in working capital	-6,234	-7,525	-372	-96	N/A
Cash flow from operations	6,805	5,653	13,662	15,074	30.4%
Capital expenditure	-2,064	-2,232	-2,210	-2,337	N/A
Free cash flow	4,741	3,421	11,452	12,737	39.0%
Valuation and leverage metrics	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	Average
Total debt/capital (%)	62.8	65.7	61.2	57.0	61.7
Net debt/EBITDA (adj) (x)	2.0	2.2	1.9	1.6	1.9
P/E (adj) (x)	20.0	21.6	23.5	24.1	22.3
EV/sales (x)	5.7	6.1	6.5	6.7	6.3
EV/EBITDA (adj) (x)	16.6	18.0	19.5	20.6	18.7
EV/EBIT (adj) (x)	17.8	19.4	21.0	22.2	20.1
Equity FCF yield (%)	4.2	3.8	1.1	1.6	2.7
P/BV (x)	8.5	10.1	12.2	11.4	10.5
Dividend yield (%)	3.2	3.0	2.9	2.8	3.0
Selected operating metrics	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E	Average
Organic sales growth (%)	12.0	5.4	5.7	5.7	7.2
Volume growth (%)	2.0	0.9	3.0	3.4	2.3
Price growth (%)	11.0	4.5	2.7	2.3	5.1

Note: FY End Dec

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Barclays Research

Price (22-Jul-2025) **USD 69.66**
 Price Target **USD 78.00**

Why OVERWEIGHT?

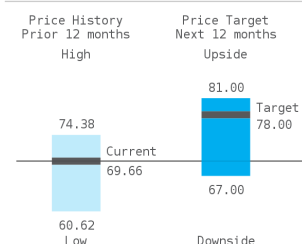
We expect KO's comprehensive transformation to re-accelerate the top and bottom line. As the company demonstrates an ability to sustainably deliver its algorithm, we expect more valuation credit to be given.

Upside case USD 81.00

Our upside case assumes that KO trades at a +LDD% premium to the more defensive, multi-national peers on upside 2026 EPS of \$3.27.

Downside case USD 67.00

Our downside case assumes that KO trades at a -MSD% discount to the more defensive, multi-national peers on downside 2026 EPS of \$3.15.

Upside/Downside scenarios

True to Form

What to do with the stock: We wouldn't necessarily say yesterday's results broke new ground in the KO story. Still, it was a solid, true-to-form print, with the quarterly performance and 2025 outlook validating why this a well-owned name in our space. The company's largely consistent strategy and tone reinforced to us the attractive and defensive positioning enjoyed by the KO System. And while there were a few modest puts and takes in our model, our EPS outlook for \$2.97 in 2025 and \$3.23 in 2026 (+LSD and +HSD YoY, respectively) remain unchanged.

Steadfast strategy with some tactical pivots. The phrase "pivot" came up several times during yesterday's discussion, but importantly this all seemed to tie to necessary tactical adjustments. A few cases in point being the decision to accelerate (and allocate additional support to) the Juntos por Cien Años campaign in Mexico in the face of elevated consumer pressure in the market, dialing up several integrated brand marketing campaigns in India following a noisy start to the summer, and greater emphasis on affordability vis a vis refillable glass in several markets. Simply put, the adjustments made so far in 2025 are primarily a response to greater macro headwinds in select markets than was likely contemplated at the time of initial 2025 business planning. Meanwhile, the strategic framework underpinned by the company's country-category resource allocation model is unchanged. And we view the steady long-term strategy as a hallmark of the KO value proposition - that is, laser-focus and consistent, gradual execution on the biggest opportunities available to the System. At a time when many other Staples companies seem like they need to evaluate (at a minimum) and/or implement potential strategic refreshes, KO continues to prove that it has the right model in place to identify and act on compelling growth opportunities across the System.

In North America specifically, the strong 2Q profitability seemed to get the most attention, but perhaps even more encouraging to us are the constructive updates across several key top line initiatives. To be sure, flat concentrate shipments in 2Q and UCV declining -1% in the quarter falls short of the volumetric results that KO aims to deliver in the region. But there were important signs of progress across several key brand families. Diet Coke volumes have grown four quarters in a row, reflecting improved momentum following the company capitalizing on social media trends recognizing the brand's distinct flavor profile, and more holistically, better supporting a dual no/low sugar platform of between Coke Zero Sugar and Diet Coke. And our understanding is that Trademark Coke improved sequentially to -1% this quarter from -3% in 1Q when the brand boycott first hit. The company also shared that the upcoming Trademark Coke extension made with cane sugar is slated for 3Q25. Consumer interest and affinity for the so-called Mexican Coke has surely existed for some time, and this launch will capitalize on that, especially at a time when attention to artificial ingredients is on the rise for certain consumers ([U.S. Consumer Staples: Increasingly \(App\)earing?](#), 06/11/25). Of note, we expect the cane sugar extension will come at a premium price point given added higher costs of sugar and glass, and supply availability on those inputs could also create a ceiling of sorts for the innovation (i.e., this is very much an addition to the Coke brand family, not a replacement of the traditional TM Coke). On the flip side, we'd point to the recent announcement of a Pepsi Prebiotic Cola, without artificial sweeteners (e.g. sweetened with a blend of cane sugar and stevia) which we understand based on a recent Beverage Digest interview with PBNA President Ram Krishnan will carry a lower price point than recently acquired Poppi (albeit more premium price point than regular Pepsi).

Outside of the Coke brand family, Bodyarmor notably grew volumes, marking great strides vs. roughly one year ago when the company was still working to stabilize the brand in the first place. And we continue to see more emphasis placed on the flavor cohort than was historically the case before KO created its global category leads, with the company scaling its consumer-

centric Sprite + Tea LTO more than originally planned after such a strong initial reception on the brand.

Changes to the model. We continue to look for \$2.97 EPS in 2025 (up ~3% YoY), which is now predicated on +5.4% OSG (from +5.1% previously), +110 bps of operating margin expansion (from +120 bps) and slightly higher net interest expense (now \$930mm from \$880mm). The upwards revision on our OSG forecast is driven primarily by the 2Q beat, while our 2H outlook is generally unchanged (now +5.4% from +5.3%). All told, we look for a 2H average that is largely in-line with the 1H average, with 3Q growth stronger than 4Q given easier comps for the former. We look for volumes +0.9% and price/mix +4.5%. Flowing through our updated 2025E FX headwind of -1.8% (from -2.4%) and our unchanged structural headwind of -0.7% brings 2025E net sales growth to +2.9%. Our margin outlook for the year is essentially reversed from our way of thinking heading into the print, with operating margin expansion now more front-half weighted (+160 bps) vs. 2H (now +60 bps) given the pull-forward of certain productivity and timing benefits of certain marketing investments. We'd also note the implied FX multiplier for 2H is larger than we had assumed previously, such that there is an additional FX-related drag to our 2H margins than we had previously built in (along with slightly lower other income now embedded below-the-line in our model to better capture lapping certain 1x hedging gains from last year). We still look for gross margin expansion in 2H (now +35 bps on average), which brings 2025E gross margins to 61.5%. And opex at 30.4% of sales brings our operating margin to 31.1% for the full year (+110 bps YoY). All in, we reiterate our \$3.23 forecast for 2026E EPS.

We reiterate our \$78 PT that assumes a +HSD% premium (unchanged) to the more defensive, multi-national peers (a ~24.0x multiple) on a P/E basis on our 2026 EPS estimate of \$3.23 (also unchanged).

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 22-Jul-2025, USD 69.66), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Coca-Cola Europacific Partners plc (CCE.AS)	Coca-Cola Europacific Partners plc (CCEP)	Colgate-Palmolive (CL)
Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Primo Brands Corporation (PRMB)	Procter & Gamble (PG)
Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)	The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)

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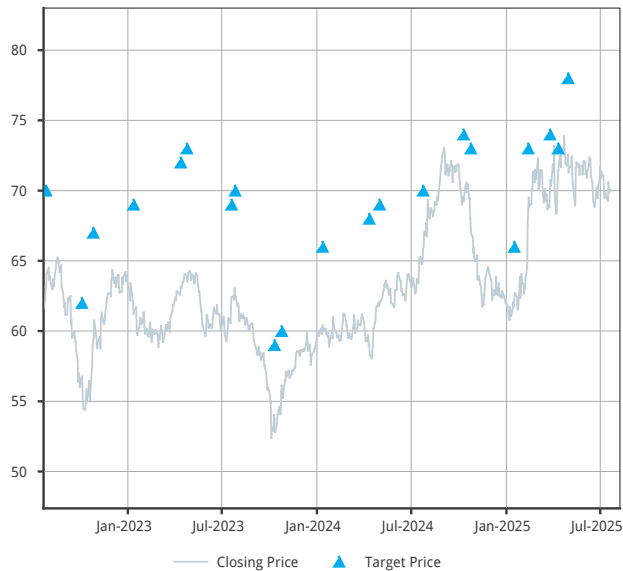
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 69.66** (22-Jul-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 22-Jul-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
30-Apr-2025	72.35		78.00
11-Apr-2025	70.76		73.00
26-Mar-2025	68.95		74.00
12-Feb-2025	67.60		73.00
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00

On 22-Jul-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 69.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$78 is based on a ~24.0x P/E reflecting a +HSD% premium to the more defensive, multinational peers on our CY26 EPS estimate of \$3.23.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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